



Programme

Master of Software Engineering – 180 credits

Course

Research Methods

MSE801

(Level 8, 15 credits, Version 1)

Assessment 2

Research Proposal and Presentation

Weighting within course:

60%

Assessment Tasks to Learning Outcome and GPOs mapping

Tasks	Learning Outcomes	GPOs
Task 1, Task 3	LO1, LO2	GPO1, GPO4
Task 2, Task 7	LO1, LO4	GPO1, GPO5
Task 4	LO2, LO3	GPO4, GPO3
Task 5	LO3	GPO3
Task 6	LO4	GPO5

Objective

The purpose of this assessment is to evaluate student's ability to provide a comprehensive plan of their research study to investigate an advanced topic in software engineering or computer science fields. The assessment is designed to prepare a comprehensive research proposal of a chosen topic with a presentation that summarises how a research proposal can be applied in a form of a review paper.

Assessment Instructions

- This assessment is an **open-book activity**, you can use your own course and review notes as well as offline or online resources, such as textbooks or online journals.
- You can always ask your tutor if you need further explanation about forming a group or if the instructions are unclear.
- The purpose of this assessment is to assess your knowledge. In the event Yoobee suspects collusion, this will be addressed. For more information on plagiarism, please refer to the Student Handbook.
- Marks and feedback will be returned within 15 days of the submission date.

Learning Outcomes (LOs)

LO1: Critically analyse literature and resources to determine appropriate research opportunities and approaches in software engineering.

LO2: Create meaningful and relevant research questions to develop creative and innovative solutions for software industry issues.

LO3: Apply appropriate methodologies, procedures, and ethical guidelines in the development of software engineering research proposals and projects.

LO4: Evaluate an optimum research schedule and process for investigating and solving software engineering industry problems.

Graduate Profile Outcomes (GPOs) covered

GPO1: Develop advanced software engineering knowledge and skills and apply these to solve emerging or existing problems.

GPO3: Develop and apply professional and ethical standards in software engineering to meet the industry's expectations and the ability to work with integrity in compliance with organisational criteria.

GPO4: Critically analyse, assess and solve software-related problems using project management tools and techniques, creative thinking and enterprise skills.

GPO5: Critically evaluate current cutting-edge research in software engineering and apply it to industry practice.

Success Criteria:

You need to meet all the requirements of each of the learning outcomes and receive 50% or more to pass this assessment. You are allowed a maximum of three attempts. To meet all the requirements of each of the learning outcomes, you must achieve PASS results for each task item.

Grading:

The final grade will be determined by the score achieved in this assessment based on the following table. Should a second or third attempt be required the maximum contribution toward the overall mark for the tasks that required a second or third assessment attempt is 50%. A late submission is considered a second attempt, so the contribution will be capped at 50%.

Grade	Mark Band Range
A+	Meet all course requirements, mark range (90-100)
A	Meet all course requirements, mark range (85-89)
A-	Meet all course requirements, mark range (80-84)
B+	Meet all course requirements, mark range (75-79)
B	Meet all course requirements, mark range (70-74)
B-	Meet all course requirements, mark range (65-69)
C+	Meet all course requirements, mark range (60-64)
C	Meet all course requirements, mark range (55-59)
C-	Meet all course requirements, mark range (50-54)
D	Did not meet all course requirements, mark range (40-49)
E	Did not meet all course requirements, mark range (0-39)

Submission requirements

Please submit your work adhering to the following guidelines:

- Only PDF or DOC files will be accepted for submission, with PDF preferred to protect your work from any changes.
- Ensure your research paper is between 6000 and 6500 words in total, excluding references.
- Use a font size of 12 for the text and 14 for headlines, with single spacing in LaTeX and proper bibliography citation.
- Font type should be Helvetica or Times New Roman. Ensure that all sources are properly cited and referenced. Citations and references should follow a consistent citation style (e.g., APA, or IEEE style).
- The final version should be a pdf document but submitting the source document such as in word or latex is desirable.
- You should submit by deadline using below structure and upload a .zip folder on Blackboard with folder name “Your name_MSE801_2” including five files as follows.

 01 Research Proposal

 02 Turnitin Report

 03 Presentation

 04 Presentation Video Record

 05 Submission Details _ World Wide Web

Assessment Tasks

Task 1: Descriptive Title of the Topic/ Introduction (LO1, LO2)

- Provide a descriptive title for your research topic.
- Introduce your topic clearly and concisely in the introduction.

Task 2: Topic Summary/ Abstract (LO1, LO4)

- Write a summary or abstract of your topic.
- Highlight the key points and objectives of your research.

Task 3: Literature Review (LO1, LO2)

- Conduct a thorough review of relevant literature.
- Summarise and analyse existing research related to your topic.

Task 4: Research Method (LO2, LO3)

- Describe the research methods you will use in your study.
- Explain how your chosen methods will help you achieve your research objectives.

Task 5: Data Availability (LO3)

- Discuss the availability of data for your study.
- Outline how you will access and analyse the data.

Task 6: Contribution of the Study (LO4)

- Explain the significance and contribution of your study to the field.
- Discuss how your research adds to existing knowledge.

Task 7: Presentation with writing style and Turnitin report (LO1, LO4)

- Ensure your writing style is clear, concise, and academic.
- Provide a Turnitin report to verify the originality of your work.

Guidelines for Research Proposal and Presentation Submission:

- Topic Approval: Email your tutor to request approval for a topic change from MSE801.1 (your first assessment), providing a clear reason for the change.
- Initial Draft: Report progress to your tutor weekly and incorporate feedback to enhance your proposal.
- Final Draft: Submit the final proposal through Blackboard.
- Turnitin Report: Ensure the report shows $\leq 20\%$ similarity and submit it along with your proposal on Blackboard.
- Presentation: Submit the presentation link on Blackboard and schedule a presentation time.
- Literature Review: Review at least 10 full papers from reliable publishers, aligning with MSE801.1 guidelines.
- Journal Submission: Submit your proposal as a review paper to a Q1/Q2 journal, aligning with the journal's area of focus.

Marking Rubric

Criteria & Weighting		E (0-39) %	D (40-49) %	C (50-64) %	B (65-79) %	A (80-100) %
Descriptive Title of the Topic/ Introduction (LO 1, LO 2)	5%	No description is provided	Inadequate description is provided.	Very limited description has been provided.	Missing some information within this section.	Descriptive title has been provided properly.
Topic Summary/ Abstract (LO 1, LO 4)	10%	No description is provided. Description is extremely poor. Very difficult to follow.	A very limited description has been provided. Poor description has been found. Difficult to follow.	Topic Description has been provided but lacks some key information. Introductory Paragraph was presented but lacks some key information. The body paragraph was poorly presented to identify the purpose of the research. Concluding paragraph was not complete.	Topic Description has been provided in fairly. The Introductory Paragraph was presented fairly with minor amendments. A body paragraph was partially presented to identify the purpose of the research. Concluding paragraph was partially summarizing and identifying the roadmap of the study. It can be further improved.	Topic Description has been provided in detail. The Introductory Paragraph was presented in an organized manner. A body paragraph was comprehensively presented to identify the purpose of the research. Concluding paragraph was excellently summarizing and identifying the roadmap of the study.
Literature Review (LO 1, LO 2)	20%	No information is provided. Discussion is extremely poor. Very difficult to follow. Analysis is completely inadequate.	Very limited information has been provided. Poor discussion has been found. Difficult to follow. Improper analysis.	The student has identified the few sources used within the article. The review was lacking important elements with reading seven full papers. The student has conducted a poor investigation of the theory. Gap has not been identified clearly. The implication of the study has not been critiqued properly.	The student has identified the number of sources used within the article. The review was comprehensive with reading twelve full papers. The student has fairly investigated the theory provided within the article to identify and analyze the gap with an excellent understanding. The implication of the study has been critiqued with a good analysis.	The student has identified the number of sources used within the article. The review was comprehensive with reading fifteen full papers. The student has investigated the theory provided within the article to identify and analyze the gap with an excellent understanding. The implication of the study has been critiqued with an outstanding analysis.

Research Method (LO 2, LO 3)	20%	No information is provided. Discussion is extremely poor. Very difficult to follow. Analysis is completely inadequate.	Very limited information has been provided. Poor discussion has been found. Difficult to follow. Improper analysis.	Discussion of the method employed within the article has not been stated clearly. Selection technique of the samples has been poorly described. Validity of the methodology has been investigated properly.	Discussion of the method employed within the article has been stated but some elements are missing. Selection technique of the samples has been fairly described in detail. Validity of the methodology has been investigated with a good analysis.	Discussion of the method employed within the article has been stated clearly. The selection technique of the samples has been described in detail. Validity of the methodology has been investigated with an in-depth analysis.
Data Availability (LO 3)	5%	Extremely limited information is provided. Discussion is very poor. Presentation is difficult to follow. Analysis is significantly flawed.	Very limited information has been provided. Poor discussion has been found. Difficult to follow. Improper analysis.	Identification of the data availability has poorly stated and missing key information. Justification of the data availability route has not been discussed properly and coherently.	Identification of the data availability has been stated in detail. Justification of the data availability route has been discussed properly and coherently at a good standard.	Identification of the data availability has been stated in detail. Justification of the data availability route has been discussed properly and coherently at a high standard.
Contribution of the Study (LO 4)	10%	No information is provided. Discussion is extremely poor. Very difficult to follow. Analysis is completely inadequate.	Very limited information has been provided. Poor discussion has been found. Difficult to follow. Improper analysis.	Contribution of the study was missing or misinterpreted. The student has poorly discussed how the future contribution will answer the research problem briefly.	Contribution of the study have been clearly stated. The student discussed how the future contribution will answer the research problem briefly.	Contribution of the study have been clearly stated. The student discussed how the future contribution will answer the research problem comprehensively.

Presentation with writing style and Turnitin report (LO 1, LO 4)	30%	Minimal information is provided. Discussion is inadequate. Presentation is challenging to follow. Analysis is incorrect or lacking.	Very limited information has been provided. Poor discussion has been found. Difficult to follow. Improper analysis.	The length of the presentation was not following the timeframe specified. Student has presented little or irrelevant information. The presentation has a poor explanation of the research problem, motivation, and methodology and missing key information. The presentation was not provided with a smooth delivery from the student. The presentation is designed unprofessionally in its structure and appearance and does not meet the criteria	The length of the presentation was nearly 10-15 minutes. Student has presented some information within a logical order and structure. The presentation has a good explanation of the research problem, motivation, and methodology. The presentation was provided with a smooth delivery from the student. The presentation is designed semi-professionally in its structure and appearance.	The length of the presentation was 15 minutes. Student has presented all necessary information within a logical order and structure. The presentation has an excellent explanation of the research problem, motivation, and methodology. The presentation was provided with a smooth delivery from the student. The presentation is designed professionally in its structure and appearance. Adding Turnitin report with <=20% similarity and following APA-V7 style.
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Note: The ranges for each grade level encompass the full 11-point grading system as outlined in the accompanying table.
 Please refer to the table for detailed percentage ranges associated with each letter grade.